

Coolendar.com

A nice scheduling webapp that is more like a to do list that focuses on tasks around a certain date. Check it out

Newsblur.com

Import your rss feeds into this neat webapp and read news directly from your favourite sites

Top 10 web services and apps of 2010

Web apps and services feature as a big part of most of our daily lives, and are mostly taken for granted, and for that reason, we'd like to pay tribute to some of the best of 2010. While some of the biggest apps and services that we have honoured have been around for a while, numerous enhancements in feature sets made this year, as well as their continued relevance in the current scenario make them eligible. Sheer ease of use and the raw capability of each web app/service was another important factor in our evaluation.

Office Web Apps

Microsoft's Office Web Apps, was released in June of this year, and has already made a mark on the web app scene. A free web-based version of Microsoft's Office productivity suite, it includes web-based versions of Microsoft's much-loved Office software, including Word, Excel, PowerPoint, and OneNote. The main advantages of cloud based Office productivity stem from anytime, anywhere accessibility, as well as online collaboration. Supported web browsers include Internet Explorer 7 and later,



Mozilla Firefox 3.5 and later, Google Chrome, and Safari 4.

The Office Web Apps service is meant to replace Office Live Workspace, and ties in with Microsoft's Skydrive storage service that offers 25 GB storage. The service is integrated with Office 2010 so you can save documents straight to the web. While it is a slightly watered down version of Office 2010, but has enough features for casual users. While it still lags behind Google Docs in features but it has much better compatibility with oft-used Microsoft Office formats.



Google Docs

Google Docs has seen quite a few changes in 2010, from abandoning IE6 to completely renovating its Docs engine. Google Docs is now one of the most comprehensive document suites online. Just this year, the Google Docs team have added nine major new features:

- Support for any kind of file on Google Docs
- Support for multiple file versions
- A thumbnail view for documents
- A web clipboard
- A completely new revamped

editor for Google Docs with real-time sharing

- Google Docs drawings editor
- OCR support for recognizing text from uploaded images
- Spellchecker, with support for adding words to the online dictionary
- Improved document revisions support
- More web fonts in editor
- Drag and drop adding images to documents

Gmail

Gmail, one of the most used email providers in world, has seen numerous updates in 2010, with plenty of Gmail Lab updates 'graduating' into the standard version, and plenty of other new features, including a revamped interface, and a new mail sorting mechanism. Other new features offered in 2010 include:

- Priority Inbox which lets automatically detects which mails are important and shows them separate from your normal mail. It learns over time.
- Better support for devices, such as Android, iPhone and iPad.
- Turning off conversation view
- Video chat for Linux
- Voice calling straight from Gmail. Can also receive calls. Ties in with Google Voice.
- Renovated contacts manager
- Access multiple Gmail accounts at once



- Drag and drop attachments to and from emails
- Nearly instant loading of Gmail windows
- Google Buzz, lots of controversy while launching, but is now quite in use
- Nested labels
- Improved account security
- Search auto-complete



Twitter

2010 saw quite a few changes incorporated into the Twitter service, and the biggest of them was a new revamped interface that was richer in media and real-time. Other new features include:

- @anywhere, Twitter integrated in other web sites so you can tweet and follow from any web site which supports @anywhere.
- Promoted tweets, tweets paid for by companies to stay on top of search results
- Promoted accounts, Twitter accounts that appear on the top of suggestions, promoted/paid for by companies
- Promoted trends
- Promoted accounts, trends and tweets opened up to 3rd parties
- The Library of Congress mission to preserve all tweets for posterity
- Twitter launched official apps for Blackberry, iPhone, iPad, Android, and Windows Phone 7
- t.co link shortening service integrated with twitter
- Geolocation support
- Completed transition to OAuth